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Co-Editors-in-Chief
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Dear Editors,

I am pleased to submit our manuscript entitled “*Quantifying the accuracy of OpenStreetMap for longitudinal cycling-infrastructure change: A reproducible validation framework using Google Street View*” for consideration in the *Journal of Transport Geography*.

This study addresses a key challenge in transport geography and cycling-infrastructure research: the lack of systematically maintained longitudinal data needed to evaluate how cycling networks change over time. In response, we develop and implement a reproducible computational workflow to reconstruct historical cycling networks from OpenStreetMap (OSM) snapshots, detect additions and removals through geometric differencing, and validate detected changes using probability-based stratified assessment with historical Google Street View imagery.

The manuscript makes both a methodological and an empirical contribution. Methodologically, it provides a transparent and transferable framework for measuring cycling-infrastructure change using volunteered geographic information and geospatial methods. Empirically, using Barcelona (2015–2023) as a case study, we show that OSM-derived snapshot differencing performs well for identifying infrastructure additions but substantially over-detects removals, largely because representational edits can be mistaken for real network loss. These findings are directly relevant to transport researchers and practitioners using OSM to study cycling-network expansion, intervention timing, and spatial inequalities in infrastructure provision.

We believe the manuscript fits the aims and scope of the *Journal of Transport Geography* because it speaks directly to the geographical dimensions of transport infrastructure change, sustainable mobility, and the use of geo-spatial methods and digital data in transport research. More specifically, the paper contributes to current work on cycling infrastructure, built environment change, and methodological developments for analysing transport and mobility across urban space.

We confirm that this manuscript has not been published previously, is not under consideration elsewhere, and that all authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission.

Thank you for considering our manuscript. We look forward to your response.

Sincerely,

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